

Daniel J. Singer

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Employment / Primary Roles

Current

Associate Professor of Philosophy University of Pennsylvania	July 2019 –
Associate Professor of Legal Studies & Business Ethics (Secondary) Wharton School of Business	July 2021 –
Editor, <i>The Philosopher's Annual</i>	June 2026 –

Past

Consultant, Boston Consulting Group	Aug. 2022 – Aug. 2024
Chair of Undergraduate Philosophy, University of Pennsylvania	July 2021 – June 2022
Assistant Professor of Philosophy, University of Pennsylvania	Jan. 2013 – June 2019
Institute for Cross-Disciplinary Engagement Fellow, Dartmouth College	Spring 2018

Specializations: Philosophy of Work, Philosophy of AI, Epistemology, Social Philosophy
Add. Interests: Ethics; Philosophy of Science; Business Ethics; Computational Methods

Education

University of Michigan, Ann Arbor

Ph.D. in Philosophy	December 2012
M.A. in Philosophy	2010

Visiting Student in Philosophy, RSSS, Australian National University 2010, 2012

University of Pennsylvania

B.A. in Logic, Information, and Computation and Philosophy (Honors)	2008
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Publications

Books

<i>What's the Point of Employment?</i>	<i>In development</i>
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This work-in-progress argues that employment should be seen as a major institution in society, akin to a police force or an educational system. Understood this way, employment stands in need of a justification that's acceptable to owners, managers, and employees alike. The purpose of employment, I argue, is to increase productive efficiency while also providing both pecuniary and non-pecuniary goods to workers. This approach to thinking about employment offers a new conception of the institution while also unifying disparate debates in business, philosophy of work, and business ethics, offering a cohesive framework for understanding topics including the nature of the firm and what makes a job good or meaningful.

Books (*continued*)

Right Belief and True Belief 2023
Oxford University Press, New York

Right Belief and True Belief likens work in epistemology about what we should believe to work in normative ethics about what we should do. It uses that analogy to draw out a methodology for epistemology that's centered around the question of what we should believe, and it defends a truth-loving consequentialist answer to that question. In doing so, the book sets the stage for a deeply truth-guided approach to all aspects of epistemology.

Articles

"Work as a State of Mind: Towards an Expressivist Theory of 'Work'" *In preparation*

"Employment Is a Relationship, Not an Exchange" *In preparation*

"Using AI Well Is Managing Well" *In preparation*

"The Distinctive Impact of AI on Science Won't Be Homogenization" *In preparation*

"Should Employees Have Voice at Work?" *Revise & Resubmit*

"The Future of AI Is Many, Not One" *Under Review*
with Garzino Demo
Preprint available here: arxiv.org/abs/2603.29075

"It's Not Always Wrong to Gaslight Employees" *Under Review*

"How Diversity Helps Jury Decisions" *Forthcoming*
with Grim, Bramson, Holman, Jung, and Berger
in *Agent-Based Modeling for Research on Groups, Networks, and Organizations*, James R. Larson, Corinne Coen (eds.), American Psychological Association

"AI slop' hides the conversations we should be having" 2026
in *npj Artificial Intelligence* (Nature Portfolio)

"The Epistemic Advantages of Representative Deliberation" 2026
with Berger, Grim, Bramson, Holman, and Jung
in *PLOS ONE*

"The Epistemic Role of Diversity in Juries: An Agent-Based Model" 2024
with Grim, Bramson, Holman, Jung, and Berger
in *Journal of Artificial Societies and Social Simulation*

Outside academia from August 2022 to August 2024, working for the Boston Consulting Group

- “Philosophical Considerations of Political Polarization”** 2022
 with Berger, Bramson, Grim, Holman, and Jung
 in *The Political Turn in Analytic Philosophy: Reflections on Social Injustice and Oppressions*, Bordonaba Plou, Fernández Castro, and Ramón Torices (eds.)
- “Epistemic Networks and Polarization”** 2021
 with Grim, Bramson, Holman, Jung, and Berger
 in *The Routledge Handbook of Political Epistemology*, Hannon and de Ridder (eds.)
- “Don’t Forget Forgetting: The Social Epistemic Importance of How We Forget”** 2021
 with Grim, Bramson, Holman, Jung, Kovaka, and Berger
 in *Synthese*
- Review of Sanford Goldberg’s *To the Best of Our Knowledge*** 2021
 in *Philosophical Review*
- “What Epistemic Reasons are For: Against the Belief–Sandwich Distinction”** 2021
 with Sara Aronowitz
 in *Meaning, Decision, and Norms: Themes from the Work of Allan Gibbard*, Billy Dunaway and David Plunkett (eds.)
- “Computational Philosophy”** 2020
 with Patrick Grim
 Entry in the *Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy*
- “Representation in Models of Epistemic Democracy”** 2020
 with Grim, Bramson, Berger, Jung, and Page
 in *Episteme*
- “Demoting Promoting Objections to Epistemic Consequentialism”** 2019
 in *Philosophical Issues*
- “A Multidisciplinary Understanding of Polarization”** 2019
 with Jung, Grim, Bramson, Berger, Holman, and Kovaka
 in *American Psychologist*
- “Diversity, Not Randomness, Trumps Ability”** 2019
 in *Philosophy of Science*
- “Rational Social and Political Polarization”** 2019
 with Bramson, Grim, Holman, Jung, Kovaka, Ranginani, and Berger
 in *Philosophical Studies*

- “Diversity, Ability, and Expertise in Epistemic Communities”** 2019
with Grim, Bramson, Holman, McGeehan, and Berger
in *Philosophy of Science*
- “Permissible Epistemic Trade-offs”** 2018
in *The Australasian Journal of Philosophy*
- “Diversity and Democracy: Agent-based Modeling in Political Philosophy”** 2018
with Holman, Berger, Grim, and Bramson
in *Historical Social Research*
- “How to be an Epistemic Consequentialist”** 2018
in *Philosophical Quarterly*
- “Understanding Polarization: Meanings, Measures, and Model Evaluation”** 2017
with Grim, Bramson, Berger, Sack, Fisher, and Flocken
in *Philosophy of Science*, Vol. 84, No. 1, p. 115-159
- “Disambiguation of Social Polarization Concepts and Measures”** 2016
with Bramson, Grim, Fisher, Sack, Berger, and Flocken
in *The Journal of Mathematical Sociology*, Vol. 40, Issue 2, p. 80-111
- “Mind the Is-Ought Gap”** 2015
in *The Journal of Philosophy*, Volume 112, Issue 4, p. 193-210
- “Germs, Genes, and Memes:
Function and Fitness Dynamics on Information Networks”** 2015
with Grim, Fisher, and Reade
in *Philosophy of Science*, Vol. 82, No. 2, p. 219-243
- “Sleeping Beauty Should be Imprecise”** 2014
in *Synthese*, Volume 191, Issue 14, p. 3159-3172
- “Scientific Networks on Data Landscapes:
Question Difficulty, Epistemic Success, and Convergence”** 2013
with Grim, Fisher, Bramson, Berger, Reade, Flocken, and Sales
in *Episteme*, Volume 10, Number 4, p. 441-464
- “Philosophical Analysis in Modeling Polarization:
Notes from a Work in Progress”** 2012
with Grim, Bramson, Fisher, Flocken, and Berger
in the APA Newsletter on Philosophy and Computers, Vol. 12, No. 1, p. 7-15
Updated and reprinted in Youngman and Hadzikadic (Editors), *Complexity and the Human Experience: Modeling Complexity in the Humanities and Social Sciences*, Pan Stanford Press, 2014

- “Polarization and Belief Dynamics in the Black and White Communities:
An Agent-Based Network Model from the Data”** 2012
with Grim, Thomas, Fisher, Reade, Garza, Fryer and Chatman
in *Artificial Life* 13, p. 186-193
- “Information Dynamics Across Linked Sub-Networks:
Genes, Germs, and Memes”** 2011
with Grim, Reade, and Fisher
in *Proceedings, AAAI Fall Symposium on Complex Systems*
- “What You Believe Travels Differently:
Information and Infection Dynamics Across Sub-Networks”** 2010
with Grim, Reade, Fisher, and Majewicz
in *Connections*, Vol. 30, No. 2, p. 50-63
- “Robustness Across the Structure of Sub-Networks:
The Contrast Between Infection and Information Dynamics”** 2010
with Grim, Reade, Fisher, and Majewicz
in *Proceedings, AAAI Fall Symposium on Complex Systems*

Grants, Awards, and Honors

- SAS Weiler Fellowship, Penn School of Arts and Sciences (\$7,500)** 2026 – 2027
Dean’s award in recognition of excellence in research and teaching
- Google Research Award for Project on AI Innovation (\$10,000)** 2025
- Penn Mellon Fellow and Provost’s Leadership Academy Participant** 2021
- Dean’s Award for Distinguished Teaching by an Assistant Professor** 2018
Penn’s School of Arts and Sciences award that recognizes one member
of the junior faculty who demonstrates unusual promise as an educator
- Price Lab for the Digital Humanities Mellon Faculty Fellow** 2016 – 2018
- SCEW (MindCORE) Grant for Agent-Based Modeling Workshop (\$6K)** Spring 2020
- GPPC Conference Grants for PeRFECt (\$3K, \$2K, \$3K, \$2.5K, \$1K)** 2014 – 2019
- SAS Conference Support Grants (\$3K, \$3K, \$2K, \$3K)** Spring 2015, 2017, 2018, 2020
- University Research Foundation Grants (\$2,000, \$2,000, \$2,000)** Spring 2015, 2017, 2020
- SAS Research Opportunity Grant (\$3,000)** Spring 2017

University Research and Dean's Grants for PRPSEW (\$4,900, \$5,000)	<i>Spring 2014, 2017</i>
Penn Provost Excellence through Diversity Grant for PeRFECt2 (\$4,000)	<i>Fall 2016</i>
Penn Undergraduate Research Mentorship (PURM) Grant (\$5,300)	<i>Summer 2016</i>
Penn Digital Humanities Forum Project Incubation Grant (\$3,000)	<i>Summer 2015</i>
Rackham International Research Grant	<i>Summer 2012</i>
Wirt and Mary Cornwell Prize Fellowship Prize for outstanding intellectual curiosity and exceptional promise of original study and creative work in Philosophy	<i>2011–2012</i>
Rackham Graduate School Research Grant	<i>Summer 2010</i>
Rackham Graduate School Travel Grants	<i>2009, 2010, 2012</i>
Marshall M. Weinberg Summer Fellowship Prize for academic distinction during early years of graduate study	<i>Summer 2009</i>
University of Michigan Philosophy Department Fellowship	<i>2009, 2010, 2011</i>
University of Michigan Summer Research Grant	<i>2009, 2010, 2011</i>

Selected Presentations and Conference Organization

The Future of AI is Many, Not One Presented at Hong Kong University	<i>March 2026</i>
What's the Point of Employment? Presented at Denison University	<i>March 2026</i>
Presented at Hong Kong University	<i>March 2026</i>
Managerial (Over)control and Why It Matters for Firms and Employees Presented at PPE Society Conference, New Orleans	<i>November 2025</i>
It's Not Always Wrong to Gaslight Employees Presented at Work and Democracy Workshop, Groningen	<i>October 2025</i>
Presented at PPE Society Conference, London	<i>July 2025</i>
The Employment Tax on Agency and Managerial Gaslighting Presented at University of North Carolina, Chapel Hill	<i>March 2025</i>

Philosopher Meets Critics: *Right Belief and True Belief*

Online discussion with Ram Neta, Amy Flowerree, and Kate Nolfi Nov. 2024
 Hosted by CONCEPT (University of Cologne) & Federal University of Bahia
 Available online at <http://youtu.be/sGb4FZNI0o>

Author Meets Critics: *Right Belief and True Belief*

Discussion with Ram Neta, Amy Flowerree, and Kate Nolfi
 Presented at the Eastern APA in New York Jan. 2024

How Management Affects Diversity

Presented at Boston Consulting Group May 2024

Psychological Safety Levels the Playing Field for Employees

Presented at Boston Consulting Group May 2023

Modelling the Epistemic Effects of Diversity and Enclaves

Presented at Hong Kong University April 2022

The Epistemic Role of Diversity in Juries

Presented at Wharton School of Business May 2021

Should Juries be Unanimous?

Presented at University of Southern California September 2020

Jury Unanimity: An Agent-Based Model Approach

Presented at Social (Distance) Epistemology Workshop May 2020
 Presented at University of Pennsylvania September 2019

Agent-Based Models of *Is* and *Ought*

Keynote at “ABMs of Scientific Inquiry,” Bochum, Germany March 2019

Knowledge for Epistemic Consequentialists

Presented at Fordham University October 2018

Models and Target Systems in Normative Inquiry

Presented at Hebrew University’s “Modeling Reality Workshop” July 2018

Rational Polarization and the Importance of Group ‘Forgets’

Presented at Dartmouth College April 2018
 Publicly Accessible Version Presented at Dartmouth ICE May 2018

Epistemic Consequentialism

Presented at the University of Vermont May 2018

- Penn Reasons and Foundations in Epistemology Conference (PeRFECT)** 2015 – 2018
Organizer with Errol Lord and Lisa Miracchi
- Permissible Epistemic Trade-offs**
Presented at Chapel Hill Normativity Workshop March 2018
- Rational Polarization and the Importance of Forgetting**
Presented at Dept. of Legal Studies and Business Ethics, Wharton February 2018
- Group Polarization as a Limitedly Rational Response to Evidence**
Presented at Price Lab for the Digital Humanities, Penn October 2017
Presented at Decisions, Games and Logic, University of Michigan July 2016
- Models of Group Deliberation: Thick and Thin**
Keynote at DebateLab Workshop on Argumentation in Opinion Dynamics,
KIT, Karlsruhe, Germany June 2017
Presented at DiMiNet, Annenberg School of Communication October 2017
- Penn-Rutgers-Princeton Social Epistemology Workshop** 2013–2017
Lead Organizer, Spring 2014, Spring 2017
Organizer, Spring 2013, Spring 2015, Spring 2016
- Sophisticated Epistemic Consequentialism**
Presented at Dartmouth January 2016
Presented at Institut Jean Nicod, Paris FR June 2016
Presented at the University of British Columbia November 2016
- Normative and Scientific Explanation**
Presented at the Eastern APA in Washington DC January 2016
Presented at the Ethics and Explanation Conference, Nottingham UK February 2016
- Votes, Talk, and Groups: Modeling Epistemic Democracy and Polarization**
Presented at Sawyer Seminar on Trust, Northwestern University May 2015
- Symposium: Computer Simulations in Philosophical Research**
Presented at the Eastern APA in Philadelphia, PA December 2014
- Why Believe the Truth**
Presented as a PhilSoc at the Australian National University July 2012
Presented at the USC/UCLA Graduate Conference March 2012
Presented at the Yale/UConn Graduate Conference April 2012
- Modeling Peer Disagreement**
Presented at the Australasian Association of Philosophy Meeting June 2012

Grounding Epistemology in Belief

Presented at the University of Pennsylvania

*April 2012***Information Dynamics Across Sub-networks:****Germes, Genes, and Memes**

With Grim, Fisher, and Reade

Presented at the AAAI Fall Symposium Series

*November 2011***The Is-Ought Gap Gap**

Presented at the Michigan Graduate Student Working Group

*December 2010***Robustness Across the Structure of Sub-Networks:****The Contrast Between Infection and Information Dynamics**

With Grim, Reade, Fisher, and Majewicz

Presented at the AAAI Fall Symposium Series

*November 2010***Some Problems for Imprecise Bayesianism**

Presented at the Australasian Association of Philosophy Conference

*July 2010***Epistemic Conservatism for Imprecise Partial Belief**

Presented at the Notre Dame/Northwestern Epistemology Conference

March 2010

Presented at the Princeton-Rutgers Graduate Conference

*April 2010***On James Harrington's "Instants and Instantaneous Velocity"**

Comments presented at the Eastern APA Symposium

*December 2009***On the Use of Isomorphisms in an Account of Similarity**

Presented at the Formal Methods in Philosophy Conference, Penn

*May 2008***Selected Professional and Academic Service**

Editor, *The Philosopher's Annual**2026 – Present***Chair of Graduate Admissions, Penn Philosophy***2024 – Present***Facilitator, Penn CETLI Faculty Cohorts on Teaching and Working with AI** *2025 – 2026***Member, Penn Presidential Commission on Open Expression***2024 – 2025***Undergraduate Chair, Penn Philosophy***2021 – 2022***Penn Arts and Sciences Curriculum Committee**

Chair

2019 – 2022

Member

2018 – 2022

Penn Arts and Sciences Committee to Revise Curricular Review Chair	2019 – 2021
Penn Arts and Sciences Committee on Undergraduate Education Ex-Officio Member	2019 – 2022
Penn Faculty Senate Executive Committee Member Representative from Philosophy and Linguistics Assistant Professor Representative	2018 – 2022 2015 – 2017
Representative to Greater Phila. Philosophy Consortium	2019 – 2021
Placement Director, Penn Philosophy	2013 – 2020
Penn Fraternity and Sorority Advisory Board	2018 – 2019
Steering Committee, Social Epistemology Network	2017 – Present
SAS Planning Group on Quantitative Explorations of Evolving Systems	2015 – 2018
Residential Faculty Fellow, Ware College House	2014 – 2018
Phi Beta Kappa Election Committee	2015 – 2017
NEH Institute - Computer Simulations in the Humanities Experienced Modelling Mentor at the NEH Institute for Advanced Topics in the Digital Humanities at the University of North Carolina at Charlotte	June 2011

Teaching

As Primary Instructor

Introduction to Mathematical Logic (Grad and Undergrad)	<i>Spr. '26, '25, '20, '15</i>
Graduate Seminar on Philosophy of Work	<i>Spring '26</i>
Knowledge and Reality	<i>F '25, F '24, F '22, F '19, F '18, Spr. '16, F '14, F '13</i>
Undergrad Seminar on AI in Work, School, and Research	<i>Fall '25</i>
Business Ethics & Social Responsibility (Wharton)	<i>Spring '25</i>
Graduate Seminar on Meaningful Work	<i>Spring '25</i>
Graduate Seminar on Epistemic Architectures	<i>Fall '24</i>
Graduate Seminar on the Value of Diversity	<i>Fall '22</i>
Introduction to Philosophy	<i>Fall '21, Spr. '19, Fall '17, Fall '15, Spr. '14</i>
Dissertation Writing Workshop	<i>Fall '21, Fall '17, Fall '13</i>
Graduate Seminar on Epistemic Normativity and Consequentialism	<i>Spring '21</i>
Graduate Seminar on Legal Epistemology	<i>Spring '20</i>
Food and Fat (Seminar on Ethics of Obesity)	<i>Fall '19, Spring '16</i>

Scientific Reasoning (Undergrad Online)	<i>Fall '19, Spring '20</i>
Graduate Seminar on the Domain of Epistemology	<i>Spring '19</i>
Graduate Proseminar	<i>Fall '18, '15, '14</i>
Graduate Seminar on Normativity in Formal Epistemology	<i>Fall '17</i>
Graduate Seminar on Social Epistemology	<i>Spring '17</i>
Graduate Seminar on Epistemic Reasons	<i>Spring '15</i>
Graduate Seminar on Epistemic Normativity	<i>Spring '14</i>
Graduate Seminar on Williamson's <i>Knowledge and its Limits</i>	<i>Spring '13</i>
Epistemology (Undergraduate Introduction)	<i>Spring '13</i>
Problems of Philosophy	<i>Spring '12</i>
Introduction to Logic (with Online Component)	<i>Summer '11</i>

University of Michigan Graduate Teacher Certificate 2012

Teaching and professional development, including courses and research on teaching, class feedback sessions and evaluations, and a teaching mentorship.

As Graduate Student Instructor

Philosophy of Mind and Language, Eric Swanson	<i>Spring '11</i>
Applied Ethics, Sarah Buss	<i>Spring '10</i>
Mathematical Logic, Richmond Thomason	<i>Fall '09</i>

As Teaching Intern and Grader

Mathematical Logic, David Baker	<i>Fall '08, Spring '09</i>
Introduction to Logic, Scott Weinstein	<i>Spring '07, Spring '08</i>